



GitHub Copilot

GitHub Copilot documentation

You can use GitHub Copilot to enhance your productivity and assist as you work on code.

1. Get started
2. Concepts
3. **How-tos**
4. Reference
5. Tutorials
6. Responsible use





GitHub Copilot

GitHub Copilot documentation | How-Tos

1. Set up
2. Get code suggestions
3. Chat with Copilot
4. Use copilot agents
5. Use AI models
6. Provide context
7. Configure custom instructions
8. Configure content exclusion
9. Use Copilot for common tasks
10. Configure personal settings
11. Manage and track spending
12. Manage your account
13. Administer Copilot
14. Troubleshoot Copilot





GitHub Copilot

How-Tos | Setup

Setting up GitHub Copilot

Learn how to set up GitHub Copilot.

1. Set up for self
2. Set up for organization
3. Set up for enterprise
4. Set up for a dedicated enterprise
5. Install Copilot extension
6. Install Copilot CLI





GitHub Copilot

Setup | Setup for self

Setting up GitHub Copilot for yourself

Follow these steps to start using Copilot.

1. Get access to GitHub Copilot

- a. Use Copilot Free
- b. Sign up for a paid plan
 - i. Copilot Pro,
 - ii. Copilot Pro+,
- c. Use Copilot through your organization or enterprise.
- d. Verified students, teachers, or open source maintainers.

2. Install the Copilot extension for your IDE

3. Install the Copilot extension for the command line

4. Use Copilot in Windows Terminal

5. Set up networking

6. Configure settings

7. Start using Copilot





GitHub Copilot

Setup | Setup for organization / enterprise

Setting up GitHub Copilot for your organization.

Follow these steps to set up GitHub Copilot in your organization.

1. Subscribe your organization to GitHub Copilot
2. Set policies
3. Set up networking (if necessary)
4. Grant access to members

Setting up GitHub Copilot for your enterprise

Follow these steps to set up GitHub Copilot in your enterprise.

1. Enable GitHub Copilot in your Enterprise through payment verification
2. Set policies
3. Set up networking (if necessary)
4. Assign licenses

Setting up a dedicated enterprise for GitHub Copilot Business

Learn how to configure an enterprise account for use with GitHub Copilot only.

1. Create an enterprise account
2. Add users to your enterprise
3. Create teams (optional)
4. Enable Copilot for the enterprise
5. Assign Copilot licenses
6. Convert your trial to a paid enterprise account

Installing the GitHub Copilot extension in your environment

To use Copilot in your preferred coding environment, follow the steps for your chosen IDE.

1. Prerequisites
2. About GitHub Copilot in VS code
3. Setting up GitHub Copilot in VS code





GitHub Copilot

Setup | Setup for organization / enterprise

Installing GitHub Copilot CLI

Learn how to install Copilot CLI so that you can use Copilot directly from the command line.

1. Prerequisites
2. Installing or updating Copilot CLI





GitHub Copilot

How-Tos | Get code suggestions

Get suggestions from GitHub Copilot

Learn how to get suggestions from GitHub Copilot.

1. Get IDE code suggestions
2. Write PR descriptions
3. Find matching code





GitHub Copilot

Get code suggs | Get IDE code suggestions

Getting code suggestions in your IDE with GitHub Copilot

Use GitHub Copilot to get code suggestions in your editor. (in VS Code)

1. Introduction

2. Prerequisites

- a. Access to Copilot
- b. Sign in to GitHub in VS code
- c. VS code
- d. Copilot in VS code

3. Getting code suggestions

- a. Accept - press "TAB"
- b. Reject - press "ESC"

4. Showing alternative suggestions

- a. Next - press "Alt +]"
- b. Previous - press "Alt + ["

5. Showing multiple suggestions

- a. Open New tab - press "Ctrl + Enter"
- b. Accept sugg - press "Accept suggestion NUMBER"
- c. Reject sugg - close the tab

6. Accepting partial suggestions

- a. Accept next word - press "Ctrl + →"

7. Navigating and accepting next edit suggestions

- a. Accept - press "Tab"
- b. Reject - press "Esc"

8. Changing AI model





GitHub Copilot

Get code suggs | Write PR descriptions

Writing pull request descriptions with GitHub Copilot text completion

Write pull request descriptions more quickly and accurately with Copilot text completion.

1. Using Copilot text completion

- a. Create PR
- b. Type your description
- c. As you type, Copilot will provide in-line suggestions based on the context of PR
- d. Review suggestions:
 - i. Accept - press "Tab"
 - ii. Reject - press "Esc"
 - iii. Continue typing, Copilot will provide new suggestions based on the additional context.
- e. Click create PR, once done.

2. Disabling or enabling Copilot text completion

- a. Create PR
- b. Select Copilot icon (top of description field) → hover over Autocomplete (Public preview):
 - i. Click Enabled or Disabled.





GitHub Copilot

Get code suggs | Find matching code

Finding public code that matches GitHub Copilot suggestions

Learn how to view code references when GitHub Copilot makes suggestions that matches publicly available code. (in VS code)

1. Introduction

2. Prerequisites

- a. Config in personal settings (in policies as individual subscriber)
- b. Config in organization settings (in policies in your organization)

3. View code reference for inline suggestions

- a. Open the Output window by selecting View > Output from the menu bar.
- b. In the dropdown menu, select GitHub Copilot Log (Code References)
- c. Leave the GitHub Copilot Log (Code References) view displayed while you use GitHub Copilot.

The log entry includes the following details:

- The date and time you accepted the suggestion.
- The name of the file in which the suggestion was added.
- "Similar code at" followed by the location in the file where the suggestion was added.
- An extract of the code that was added by the inline suggestion.
- The license type for the matching code, if found, otherwise unknown.
- The URL of the file on GitHub.com where the similar code was found.

4. View code reference for Copilot Chat

- a. Click View matches to display details of the matched code in a new editor tab.
- b. Click "Ctrl + click" a URL to view the full file on GitHub.com.





GitHub Copilot

How-Tos | Chat with Copilot

1. Get Started with Chat
2. Chat in IDE
3. Chat in Windows Terminal
4. Chat in GitHub
5. Chat in Mobile





Chat with Copilot | Get started with chat

Getting started with prompts for GitHub Copilot Chat

Get an overview of ways to use Copilot Chat.

Setup env:

- Chat: GitHub Copilot Chat in IDE VS Code

Prompt usage strategies:

- chat participants (preceded by @) - extensions
 - slash commands (preceded by /) - commands
 - chat variables (preceded by #) - context
1. Ask general software questions
 2. Ask questions about your project
 - a. Highlight relevant lines of code
 - b. Use chat variables - #selection, #file, #editor, #codebase, or #git
 - c. Use @workspace chat participant.
 3. Write code
 4. Ask questions about alerts from GitHub Advanced Security features like
 - a. Code scanning,
 - b. Secret scanning,
 - c. Dependabot alerts
 5. Set up a new project
 - a. Use chat commands /new
 6. Fix, improve, and refactor code
 - a. Use chat commands /fix
 7. Write tests
 - a. Use chat commands /text
 8. Ask questions about VS code
 - a. Use chat participant @vscode
 9. Ask questions about command line
 - a. Use chat participant @terminal





GitHub Copilot

Chat with Copilot | Get started with chat

Setup env:

- Chat: GitHub Copilot Chat in Browser website
1. Ask general software questions
 2. Ask questions about a repository
 3. Ask questions about a specific file or symbol
 4. Ask questions about a knowledge base
 5. Ask questions about a specific piece of code
 6. Ask questions about alerts from GitHub Advanced Security products
 7. Ask Copilot Chat questions in a pull request
 8. Ask Copilot Chat questions about a specific issue or discussion
 9. Ask Copilot Chat questions about a specific commit





Chat with Copilot | Chat in IDE

Asking GitHub Copilot questions in your IDE

Use Copilot Chat in your editor to give you code suggestions, explain code, generate unit tests, and suggest code fixes. (in **VS Code**)

1. Introduction
2. Pre-requisites
 - a. Access to GitHub Copilot
 - b. Latest version of Visual Studio Code.
 - c. Sign in to GitHub in Visual Studio Code.
3. Submitting prompts
 - a. Open the chat view
 - b. Enter a prompt
 - c. Evaluate Copilot's response
4. Using keywords in your prompt
 - a. Chat participants (@) - domain experts
 - b. Slash commands (/) - complex prompts
 - c. Chat variables (#) - context
5. Using GitHub skills for Copilot (@github)
6. Using Model Context Protocol (MCP) servers
7. AI models for Copilot Chat
8. Additional ways to access Copilot Chat
 - a. Quick chat (ctrl+shif+alt+L)
 - b. Inline chat (ctrl+i)
 - c. Smart actions (sparkle icon, when code selection)
9. Copilot Chat chat modes
 - a. Ask - to understand how something works, explore ideas, or get help with coding tasks.
 - b. Edit - to make a quick, specific update to a defined set of files.
 - c. Agent - when task is complex, and involves multiple steps, iterations, and error handling, autonomously edit your code.
 - d. Subagents - to delegate tasks to an isolated agent.
 - e. Plain - to create detailed implementation plans.
10. Using images in Copilot Chat
11. Sharing feedback





GitHub Copilot

Chat with Copilot | Chat in WIN terminal

Asking GitHub Copilot questions in Windows Terminal

You can use Copilot in Windows Terminal to get suggestions and explanations for the command line.

1. Prerequisites
 - a. Access to GitHub Copilot
 - b. Windows Terminal Canary installed
 - c. GitHub Copilot connected to Terminal Chat.
2. Getting command explanations and suggestions
3. Sharing feedback





Chat with Copilot | Chat in GitHub

Asking GitHub Copilot questions in GitHub

You can use GitHub Copilot Chat in GitHub to answer general questions about software development, or specific questions about the issues or code in a repository.

1. Introduction
2. Submitting a question to Copilot Chat
 - a. Raising a question
 - b. Viewing and editing generated files within Copilot Chat
 - c. Regenerating a response with a different model
 - d. Using sub threads in a conversion
3. Powered by skills
4. Asking Copilot Chat questions in different contexts
5. Using images in Copilot Chat
 - a. Attaching an image to your chat prompt
6. Accessing Copilot Chat from the search bar
7. Accessing Copilot Chat from the dashboard
8. Sharing Copilot Chat conversations
9. Sharing feedback about GitHub Copilot Chat in GitHub





GitHub Copilot

Chat with Copilot | Chat in Mobile

Asking GitHub Copilot questions in GitHub Mobile

You can use GitHub Copilot Chat in GitHub Mobile to answer general questions about software development, or specific questions about the code in a repository.

1. Overview
2. Limitations
3. Prerequisites
4. Asking a general question about software development
5. Asking exploratory questions about a repository
6. Asking questions about specific pieces of code
7. Extending Copilot Chat in GitHub Mobile
8. Hiding Copilot Chat
9. Sharing feedback about GitHub Copilot Chat in GitHub Mobile

